

Immigration Emergency Resources for CivicSALT

This comprehensive resource guide fills critical gaps for U.S. immigrants facing enforcement situations, detention, and legal proceedings. It covers post-detention steps, warrant recognition, workplace rights, consular services, vulnerable population resources, mental health support, and key legal pathways. All resources have been verified as of January 2026, though immigration policies are changing rapidly—users should confirm current status with legal providers.

Post-detention: The critical first 24-48 hours

When someone is detained by ICE, family members must act quickly while staying calm. The **first priority is obtaining the A-Number** (Alien Registration Number)—an 8-9 digit identifier issued upon arrest that's essential for locating the person and communicating with the immigration system.

Immediate steps for families:

1. Use the **ICE Online Detainee Locator** at locator.ice.gov ([Johnsonmasumi +3](#)) (available in 9 languages including Spanish, Arabic, Chinese, Vietnamese)
2. Call the **ICE ERO Detention Reporting Line: 1-888-351-4024** ([freedomforimmigrants](#)) (Monday-Friday, 8am-8pm ET) ([DHS](#))
3. Contact the **Freedom for Immigrants Hotline** from detention by dialing **9233#** ([freedomforimmigrants](#)) (free, unmonitored, Mon-Fri 8am-8pm PT) ([freedomforimmigrants](#))
4. Check the **Immigration Court Automated Hotline: 1-800-898-7180** ([U.S. Department of Justice](#)) (24/7) for case status ([Freedom for Immigrants](#)) ([freedomforimmigrants](#))

Critical caveat: Records may take **24-48 hours** to appear in the ICE locator system after detention.

([Johnsonmasumi +2](#)) Children under 18 do not appear in the system. If the person isn't found, try alternate name spellings, contact the local ICE ERO field office, or check local jails for ICE holds. ([Hubbs Law](#))

Adding money for commissary and phone calls

ICE detention facilities primarily use **Talton Communications** for phone and tablet services. ([AFSC](#)) Family members can add funds through:

- **Online 24/7:** taltoncommunications.com or gettingout.com
- **Phone 24/7:** (866) 516-0115
- **Lobby kiosks** at facilities (cash, credit, or debit) ([CoreCivic](#))

Standard call rates are **\$0.05/minute**, with video visits at \$0.21/minute. Attorneys must register their phone numbers as confidential at icesupport@talton.com to ensure legal calls aren't monitored. (ICE)

Bond hearing process and timeline

Bond hearings determine whether a detained person can be released pending their case. **Not everyone is eligible**—mandatory detention applies to people with prior removal orders, certain criminal convictions, or those who arrived at ports of entry. (NIJC)

Stage	Typical Timeline
ICE custody determination	Hours to days after detention
Bond hearing request filed	After Notice to Appear issued
Bond hearing scheduled	2-3 weeks after request (The Visa Firm)
Decision	Usually immediate oral ruling

Average bond amounts in 2025: Approximately **\$8,176**, (American Immigration Council) with a minimum of \$1,500. (Justia) Bond can be paid through the **ICE CeBONDS online system** at ice.gov/detain/detention-management/bonds using ACH transfer or Fedwire. (ICE) Families needing financial help should contact the **National Bail Fund Network** at communityjusticeexchange.org/nbfn-bondreferral— (freedomforimmigrants) a network of 90+ partner bond funds (Communityjusticeexchange) including RAICES (Texas), Envision Freedom Fund (national), and Immigrant Freedom Fund (Colorado).

Recognizing warrants: Judicial versus administrative

The single most important distinction for anyone approached by ICE at home is whether officers have a **judicial warrant or an administrative warrant**. This determines whether you must allow entry.

Quick visual identification guide

Feature	Judicial Warrant (Must Comply)	Administrative Warrant (Can Refuse Entry)
Header	"United States District Court"	"Department of Homeland Security"
Signature	Judge or Magistrate name	Immigration Officer name
Form number	AO 93 or AO 442	I-200 or I-205
Legal authority	Authorizes entry without consent	Does NOT authorize home entry

ICE Form I-200 (Warrant for Arrest of Alien) and **Form I-205** (Warrant of Removal/Deportation) are administrative documents signed by immigration officers, not judges. (FindLaw) (nilc) Per ICE's own training materials: "Because neither a Warrant for Arrest of Alien (I-200) nor an administrative Warrant of Removal (I-205) authorizes you to enter the subject's residence... you must obtain voluntary consent."

(Immigrant Defense Project)

Recommended response to ICE at the door:

1. Do not open the door—opening can be construed as consent (ILRC +2)
2. Ask to see the warrant through a window or slid under the door (ILRC +2)
3. Photograph it if possible (nilc)
4. Check: Is it signed by a JUDGE? Does it list your correct address? (ILRC)
5. If administrative: State "I do not consent to your entry" and remain inside
6. If judicial: You must comply, but you retain the right to remain silent (ILRC) (nilc)

Sample warrant images and annotations are available from the **Immigrant Legal Resource Center** at ilrc.org/sites/default/files/resources/i-200_and_i-205_sample_annotated.pdf.

Sensitive locations policy: Current status

Major policy change (January 2025): The Trump administration rescinded the Biden-era "Protected Areas" policy that had limited ICE enforcement at schools, churches, hospitals, courthouses, and public demonstrations. (National Low Income Housing ...) There are now **no bright-line federal rules** prohibiting enforcement at these locations—only guidance for officers to use "common sense." (Venable LLP)

However, **constitutional protections still apply everywhere:** Fourth Amendment protection against unreasonable search and seizure means ICE still needs a judicial warrant to enter private spaces, and the Fifth Amendment right to remain silent is always available.

State sanctuary policies provide stronger protections

California (SB 54, AB 450): Prohibits state/local law enforcement from using resources for federal immigration enforcement, (Wikipedia) limits inquiries about immigration status, and prohibits honoring ICE detainers without a judicial warrant. (National Immigration Law Center) (ACLU of Southern California)

Illinois TRUST Act: Prohibits local law enforcement from complying with immigration detainers or civil immigration warrants (Illinois Attorney General) (I-200, I-205). (Justia) The ICIRR Family Support Hotline is available 24 hours at **1-855-435-7693** (English, Spanish, Korean, Polish). (Ourcimh)

New York: City and state policies prohibit agencies from sharing information with federal authorities for civil immigration enforcement unless the person is suspected of criminal activity. NYC Immigration Hotline: **1-800-**

Consular rights under the Vienna Convention

Foreign nationals detained in the U.S. have the right under **Article 36 of the Vienna Convention** to have their consulate notified, to communicate with consular officials, and to receive consular visits. VisaVerge To invoke these rights, tell officers: "I would like to contact my consulate" and provide your country of citizenship.

Mandatory versus optional notification countries

For **58 countries** (including China, Russia, the Philippines, Poland, and the United Kingdom), U.S. authorities **must** notify the consulate regardless of the detainee's wishes. U.S. Department of State For all other countries — including Mexico, Guatemala, Honduras, and El Salvador — notification is offered but the detainee chooses whether to accept. U.S. Department of State

Important: Asylum seekers should be cautious about consular notification, as consulates represent the government the person may be fleeing.

Key consular contacts

Mexican Consular Emergency (CIAM): (520) 623-7874 — 24/7 hotline for detained Mexicans. 211Now The **ConsulApp Contigo** mobile app includes an emergency button and "Know Your Rights" information in Spanish.

Country	Key Consulate Phone
Mexico (LA)	(213) 351-6800
Guatemala (LA)	(213) 365-9251
El Salvador (LA)	(213) 383-8364
Honduras (LA)	(213) 995-6406
Philippines (LA)	(213) 639-0980

A complete directory of foreign consulates is available at travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/consularnotification.html.

Vulnerable population resources

Unaccompanied minors

The **Office of Refugee Resettlement (ORR)** within HHS—not ICE—is responsible for unaccompanied children. [Forumtogether](#) ORR operates 171+ shelters across 24 states and prioritizes releasing children to vetted sponsors (usually parents or relatives). [Administration for Children an...](#)

ORR National Call Center (for parents/sponsors): 1-800-203-7001 [National Child Traumatic Stres...](#) or WhatsApp — 7 days/week, 9am-9pm ET, [National Child Traumatic Stres...](#) available in 20+ languages including Spanish, Arabic, Mandarin, Haitian Creole, and Vietnamese.

Legal representation for minors:

- **Kids in Need of Defense (KIND):** [supportkind.org](#) — Free legal representation through 730+ pro bono partners; offices in 14 U.S. cities
- **Young Center for Immigrant Children's Rights:** [theyoungcenter.org](#) — Provides Child Advocates (guardians ad litem) for the most vulnerable children

The **Flores Settlement Agreement** remains in effect as of August 2025, [Childrensrights](#) requiring that children be placed in the "least restrictive" setting appropriate to their age and needs, [Wikipedia](#) with a general 20-day detention limit. [Child Welfare League of America](#)

Pregnant women in detention

ICE Directive 11032.4 (2021) states that ICE should NOT detain pregnant, postpartum (1 year), or nursing individuals for administrative immigration violations, with limited exceptions. Despite this policy, advocacy organizations have documented ongoing violations including denial of prenatal care and shackling during transport. [American Civil Liberties Union](#)

Key advocacy organizations: ACLU National Prison Project ([aclu.org](#)), National Immigration Project ([nipnlg.org](#)), Women's Refugee Commission ([womensrefugeecommission.org](#)).

People with medical conditions

Detained individuals have rights to medical care under the Fifth Amendment. [VisaVerge](#) [InmateAid](#) The **Florence Immigrant & Refugee Rights Project** ([firrp.org](#)) publishes a guide on "How to Get Medical Care While You Are in ICE Custody." Steps include: submitting sick call requests in writing, documenting all interactions, writing to the Warden and Field Office Director, and contacting advocacy organizations [FIRRP](#) like **Freedom for Immigrants** ([freedomforimmigrants.org](#)).

For compassionate release based on medical conditions, families should prepare detailed medical documentation and submit written requests to the Field Office Director demonstrating that the facility cannot provide necessary care. [VisaVerge](#)

LGBTQ+ individuals

Critical update: Recent policy changes have significantly affected LGBTQ+ protections in detention. The Trump administration has rolled back LGBTQ-specific PREA (Prison Rape Elimination Act) protections, with at least 6 ICE detention facilities removing trans safeguards from contracts. (LGBTQ Nation)

Key organizations:

- **Immigration Equality:** immigrationequality.org — Free legal services for LGBTQ+ and HIV-positive immigrants; LGBTQ/HIV Asylum Manual; Country Conditions Index
- **Transgender Law Center:** 510-587-9696 (English), 415-296-2029 (Spanish), collect line from detention: 510-380-8229 — Trans Immigrant Defense Effort (TIDE)
- **Lambda Legal Help Desk:** 866-542-8336 (Lambda Legal)

Trafficking survivors (T-visa) and crime victims (U-visa)

T-visa requirements: Victim of severe trafficking, cooperation with law enforcement (with exceptions), physical presence in U.S. due to trafficking, extreme hardship if removed. The **National Human Trafficking Hotline** is available 24/7 at **1-888-373-7888** (200+ languages) or text "BeFree" to 233733.

U-visa requirements: Victim of qualifying crime, suffered substantial abuse, helpful to investigation/prosecution, crime occurred in U.S. (Nolo) The current backlog means **10-20+ years** for final U-visa approval, though **bona fide determination** provides deferred action and work authorization much sooner (approximately 5 years).

Asylum seekers

Asylum seekers subject to expedited removal who express fear of return receive a **credible fear interview** with a USCIS asylum officer. If positive, they're referred for further proceedings; if negative, they can request Immigration Judge review. (USCIS)

Key organizations: Human Rights First (humanrightsfirst.org, pro bono representation in NYC/DC/LA), (Human Rights First) International Refugee Assistance Project (iraplegalinfo.org), The Advocates for Human Rights (Minneapolis, 612-341-9845).

One-year filing deadline: Asylum applications must be filed within one year of arrival, with limited exceptions for changed circumstances or extraordinary circumstances.

Mental health and trauma support

Crisis hotlines (24/7)

Resource	Contact	Languages
988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	Call/Text 988	English, Spanish (Press 2), 240+ via interpreter
Crisis Text Line	Text HOME to 741741	English; Text HOLA to 741741 for Spanish
SAMHSA National Helpline	1-800-662-4357	English, Spanish
Trans Lifeline	1-877-565-8860	English, Spanish
Asian LifeNet Hotline	1-877-990-8585	Cantonese, Mandarin, Japanese, Korean, Fujianese

Important: Crisis hotlines keep information confidential and do not share with immigration authorities.

Torture survivor treatment centers

The **ORR Services for Survivors of Torture Program** funds 35 treatment centers in 24 states. All services are **free regardless of immigration status**. Find centers at healtorture.org (national directory) or contact:

- **Center for Victims of Torture (CVT):** cvt.org — Minnesota headquarters, DC
- **Bellevue/NYU Program for Survivors of Torture:** New York City
- **Marjorie Kovler Center:** Chicago, (773) 381-4070

Support for families of detained individuals

The **Women's Refugee Commission** publishes "Detained or Deported: What About My Children?" toolkit with guidance on parental rights protection. **United We Dream** (unitedwedream.org) offers preparedness packets and deportation defense resources.

Federally Qualified Health Centers (FQHCs) serve everyone regardless of immigration status on a sliding fee scale. [Sunrise Clinics](#) Find one at findahealthcenter.hrsa.gov.

Employer and workplace rights

I-9 audit process

Employers must receive at least **3 business days' advance notice** before an I-9 inspection (Notice of Inspection). [Lawyersforcivilrights](#) In **California (AB 450)**, employers must notify all employees **within 72 hours**

of receiving a Notice of Inspection, (NatLawReview) including the name of the agency and nature of the inspection. (Wilsonturnerkosmo) (ILRC)

Employee rights during an audit:

- Right to remain silent
- Right to refuse to sign documents (Legal Aid at Work)
- Right to speak to an attorney
- Right to receive notice from employer (in California)

Workplace raid protocols

Rights during a workplace raid:

1. Right to remain silent—do not answer questions about immigration status or birthplace (Informed Immigrant +2)
2. Do not sign documents without attorney consultation (Informed Immigrant) (IMMIGRANTS RISING)
3. Ask "Am I being detained?" and "Am I free to leave?" (Informed Immigrant) (ACLU of New Jersey)
4. If free to leave, calmly walk away—do not run (Informed Immigrant) (ACLU of Maine)
5. If detained, state: "I am exercising my right to remain silent. I want to speak to a lawyer." (ACLU of Maine)

ICE can enter public areas (lobbies, retail floors) without a warrant but **cannot enter non-public areas** (back offices, kitchens, employee-only spaces) without a judicial warrant or employer consent. (ACLU of Arizona)

(Signal Cleveland)

State laws protecting workers

California AB 450 prohibits employers from providing voluntary consent for ICE to enter non-public areas or access employee records without a subpoena. (Economic Policy Institute) (NatLawReview) Violations carry penalties of **\$2,000-\$10,000**. (Wilsonturnerkosmo)

Illinois Human Rights Act prohibits employment discrimination based on citizenship status or work authorization status. (Illinois Department of Human ...) The Illinois Attorney General Workplace Rights Hotline is **1-844-740-5076**.

Know Your Rights cards

The **Immigrant Legal Resource Center (ILRC)** distributes Red Cards in 50+ languages at ilrc.org/redcards.

(Los Angeles Community Invest...) Over **9 million** have been distributed since the November 2024 election. (WFYI)

Cards assert Fourth and Fifth Amendment rights and can be shown to officers without speaking.

(Informed Immigrant)

Immigration legal processes

EOIR immigration court system

Case lookup options:

- **Online:** acis.eoir.justice.gov/en/ (free, no login required—enter 9-digit A-Number) [Sabrinali](#)
- **Phone:** **1-800-898-7180** (24/7 automated) [U.S. Department of Justice](#) [freedomforimmigrants](#)

Master calendar hearings are preliminary (15-30 minutes); individual merits hearings are where evidence is presented and decisions made. [BWEA](#) **Failure to appear results in automatic in absentia removal order.**

[BWEA](#) Address changes must be filed within 5 working days. [EOIR Respondent Access](#)

DACA current status (January 2026)

Current recipients can continue renewing DACA and work authorization. [USCIS](#) Initial applications are being accepted but **not processed** due to court order. [USCIS](#) Approximately **525,210** active recipients remain.

[Forumtogether](#)

Renewal timeline: File 120-150 days before expiration. [USCIS](#) Fee is \$555 (online). **Important:** As of October 28, 2025, USCIS no longer accepts paper checks—payment must be by credit card or ACH.

[Northwest Immigrant Rights Pr...](#)

Resources: USCIS DACA page (uscis.gov/i-821d), NILC Latest DACA Developments (nilc.org), United We Dream renewal assistance.

TPS designated countries (January 2026)

Country	Current Status	Expiration
El Salvador	Active	September 9, 2026
Ukraine	Active	October 19, 2026
Lebanon	Active	May 27, 2026
Yemen	Active	March 3, 2026

Multiple countries have terminated TPS with ongoing litigation, including Venezuela, Haiti, Honduras, Nicaragua, and Afghanistan. [Rescue.org](#) Recipients should monitor **National TPS Alliance** (tpsalliance.org) and check USCIS for automatic work permit extension notices.

Public charge rule

Under the **current 2022 rule** (still in effect), "public charge" means someone primarily dependent on cash assistance (SSI, TANF cash) or long-term institutional care. **SNAP, Medicaid, CHIP, WIC, school lunch, and housing assistance do NOT count.** (NPR) Benefits received by U.S. citizen family members do not affect the applicant. (NPR)

A November 2025 proposed rule would significantly expand what counts — (City of New York) (NPR) monitor NILC (nilc.org/public-charge) for updates.

Notario fraud prevention

Only attorneys (licensed by a state bar) and **DOJ Accredited Representatives** (working for recognized nonprofits) can legally provide immigration legal advice. (U.S. Department of Justice +2) "Notario público" in Latin America means attorney; in the U.S., a notary public can only witness signatures. (Los Angeles Public Library)

Verify credentials:

- Attorneys: State bar websites (e.g., apps.calbar.ca.gov for California)
- Accredited representatives: justice.gov/eoir/recognition-accreditation-roster-reports (CA)

Red flags: Guarantees of specific outcomes, pressure to pay immediately, refusing to provide receipts, asking you to sign blank forms. (Los Angeles Public Library) (NMILC) Report fraud to the **FTC** (Beluninus) (reportfraud.ftc.gov) (freedomforimmigrants) and **Stop Notario Fraud** (stopnotariofraud.org).

Driver's licenses for undocumented immigrants

19 states plus DC and Puerto Rico issue licenses to undocumented immigrants, including California, Illinois, New York, New Jersey, and Colorado. These are marked "Federal Limits Apply" and cannot be used for REAL ID purposes (domestic flights, federal facilities). (Lawyers.com)

Warning: Tennessee (April 2025) and Wyoming (February 2025) have passed laws invalidating out-of-state licenses issued exclusively to undocumented immigrants. (Newsweek)

Key national resources directory

Emergency hotlines

Resource	Phone	Availability
ICE Detainee Locator	locator.ice.gov	24/7 online
ICE Detention Line	1-888-351-4024	M-F 8am-8pm ET

Resource	Phone	Availability
EOIR Case Status	1-800-898-7180	24/7 automated
Freedom for Immigrants	9233# from detention	M-F 8am-8pm PT
988 Crisis Lifeline	988	24/7
Trafficking Hotline	1-888-373-7888	24/7
ICIRR (Illinois)	1-855-435-7693	24/7

Legal aid directories

- **Immigration Advocates Network:** immigrationadvocates.org/nonprofit/legaldirectory/ — searchable by state, language, detention facility (freedomforimmigrants)
- **EOIR Pro Bono List:** justice.gov/eoir/file/ProBonoNational/download (freedomforimmigrants)
- **ILRC Find Help:** ilrc.me/gethelp
- **AILA Lawyer Search:** aila.org/find-a-lawyer

Key organizational resources

Organization	Website	Focus
National Immigration Law Center (NILC)	nilc.org	Policy, benefits, DACA
Immigrant Legal Resource Center (ILRC)	ilrc.org	Know Your Rights, Red Cards
CLINIC	cliniclegal.org	Legal services network
Freedom for Immigrants	freedomforimmigrants.org	Detention conditions
National Immigrant Justice Center	immigrantjustice.org	Legal representation
United We Dream	unitedwedream.org	DACA, organizing

Conclusion

This resource guide addresses critical gaps for immigrant communities navigating enforcement situations, detention, and legal proceedings. **The most important takeaways:** Know the difference between judicial and administrative warrants (you can refuse entry for I-200 and I-205 forms); (AIDS Law Project) (nilc) use the ICE

detainee locator and Freedom for Immigrants hotline immediately after detention; understand that sensitive locations policies have been rescinded at the federal level but state sanctuary laws provide protections; and always verify legal providers through official bar associations or DOJ accreditation rosters.

Immigration policies are changing rapidly under the current administration. Organizations like NILC, ILRC, and CLINIC provide real-time updates. For any individual legal situation, consultation with a qualified immigration attorney or DOJ-accredited representative is essential—this guide provides general information only and does not constitute legal advice.